nations. The Government of India was unable to send any representative for the deliberations as in the absence of any authentic copy of the American plan they had not been able to consider the proposals. Following the discussions, the US plan was revised and issued on July 10, 1943, a copy of which was sent to the Finance Member by Morgenthau.

The main changes made in the revised White plan were: (i) the proportion of gold in quota subscription was raised substantially; (ii) when the gold and exchange holdings of a member exceeded 50 percent of the quota, the member was required to make one half of the payment in respect of foreign exchange bought from the Fund, in gold or foreign exchange acceptable to the Fund; (iii) only one half of the gold and foreign exchange acquired in excess of a member's official holdings at the time of joining the Fund was to be offered by the member for sale to the Fund and that too only if the member's official holdings were in excess of 25 percent of its quota, and (iv) blocked balances purchased by the Fund were not to exceed in the aggregate 10 percent of the quota of all members, in the first two years. The revised plan deleted the Fund's power to accept deposits in gold from members.[7]

By the time the Conference was held in Bretton Woods in 1944, Keynes aware that whatever was put forward had to have the support of both the US government and American public opinion, had started to support the reformulated White plan that abandoned the gold standard and made the International Monetary Fund the custodian of a financial system based on fixed but adjustable exchange rates, pegged to the US dollar. 'A parallel institution called the World Bank would be set up, responsible for development. It did not escape comment that the fund was thus really a bank, whereas the bank was really a fund.'[8]

THE RESERVE BANK AND THE PLANS

While India shared the world's interest in the drawing up of post-war currency plans, she had a special concern in the plans given the vast accumulation of sterling balances built up during the war. As the *History* observes, 'India was keen to secure the establishment of an order which would not only safeguard the value of these balances after the war but also enable her to draw on these in a manner best suited to her post-war